Lieutenant General (then Major General) Naseem Rana, 1995–October 1998
Lieutenant General Ziauddin Butt, October 1998–October 1999
Lieutenant General Mahmud Ahmad, October 1999–October 2001
Lieutenant General Ehsan ul Haq, October 2001–October 2004
Lieutenant General Ashfaq Parvez Kayani, October 2004–October 2007
Lieutenant General Nadeem Taj, October 2007–October 2008
Lieutenant General Ahmad Shuja Pasha, October 2008–Present

Short Timeline of Events in Pakistan

1947 Pakistan gains independence from British Empire, fights first war with India over Kashmir.
1958 Ayub Khan overthrows civilian government, creates first military dictatorship.
1965 Second Pakistani war with India ends in stalemate.
1971 Third Pakistani war with India ends in Pakistan's defeat, creation of Bangladesh, and removal of second military dictator, Yahya Khan.
1977 Zia ul-Haq overthrows Zulfikar Bhutto and rules as third military dictator.
1979 Soviet invasion of Afghanistan starts mujahedin war.
1988 Soviet forces evacuate Afghanistan, Zia dies in airplane crash.
1990 President George H. W. Bush invokes Pressler Amendment, cutting off all aid to Pakistan.
1994 Taliban movement created in Afghanistan, takes Kabul in 1996.
1999 Pakistan and India fight war in Kargil, Musharraf overthrows Nawaz Sharif.
2001 September 11 attacks, U.S. intervention in Afghanistan.
2007 Benazir Bhutto assassinated after returning home from exile.
2008 Musharraf removed from office, Benazir's husband, Asif Ali Zardari, becomes president.